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HTML tables 30m

What are HTML tables?

Tables can be created in HTML using the `<table>` element. This allows web developers to easily arrange data in a table. To create a table, you will have one `<table>` element as well as the elements to define the table's header row content, cells, rows and footer content. The elements that can be used to create a table are explained in the table below.

A table cell doesn't just support plain text – you can also insert HTML elements such as images, lists and links.

Tag	Description
<code><table></code>	Defines an HTML table
<code><th></code>	Defines the heading cells in the table
<code><tr></code>	Defines a row in the table
<code><td></code>	Defines a cell in the table
<code><caption></code> <code>></code>	Specifies the caption of the table
<code><thead></code>	Defines the header content of the table. It is used to apply CSS styles as this element groups the header content in a table.

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<code><tbody></code>	Defines the body content of the table. It is used to apply CSS styles as this element groups the body content in a table.
<code><tfoot></code>	Defines the footer content of the table. It is used to apply CSS styles as this element groups the footer content in a table.

Below is an example of how to create a table. We've created a table to display the general information for BIT703. As you can see, we've displayed the level, credits and number of teaching weeks in the table.

Have a go at editing the code to see if you can add additional rows and cells.



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HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<html>
<style>
  table, th, td {
    background-color: #D6EEEE;
    text-align: center;
  }
</style>
<body>
  <h2>Web Technologies - BIT703
</h2>
  <h3>General Information</h3>
  <table style="width:100%">
    <tr>
      <th>Level</th>
      <th>Credits</th>
      <th>Teaching
Weeks</th>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td>7</td>
      <td>20</td>
      <td>16</td>
    </tr>
  </table>
</body>
</html>
```

Resources1x0.5x0.25xRerun

Example 5.18 Tables



☒ Creating a table

Non-Assessed

Status: Done
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Reset ↺

1. Using the code presented in the CodePen example 5.18, see if you can create an additional table below the current general information table. The purpose of this additional table is to display assessment information. Your table needs to include:
 - a. A caption called 'Additional information'.
 - b. A table heading. The first row must contain three headers: 'Assessment', 'Textbooks' and 'Computer requirements'.
 - c. The second row must have the following information:
 - i. Under the 'Assessment' heading, include the information 'This course is 100% internally assessed'.
 - ii. Under the 'Textbooks' heading, include the information 'No textbooks are needed for this course'.
 - iii. Under the 'Computer requirements' heading, include the information 'To complete this course, you will need access to a laptop or desktop computer'.
2. The image below shows an example of what you should be creating.

Web technologies - BIT703

Additional information

Level	Credits	Teaching weeks
7	20	16
Assessment	Textbooks	Computer requirements
This course is 100% internally assessed	No textbooks are need for this course	To complete this course you will need access to a laptop or desktop computer

Screenshot © codepen.io

☒ I have completed this activity



Compare your code to ours. Is yours similar?

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Task: Creating a table

Previous attempts ▼



Attributes can be used to customise a table, such as adding or changing a border, padding and border spacing. The reading below provides a comprehensive guide to attributes that can be used in the table elements, including relevant examples.

You can customise a table using attributes. Common customisations are:

- adding a border
- adding padding (that is, increasing the space between content and the border)
- adding a collapsed border
- changing the alignment of the table
- adding a background colour.

However, all of these customisations require the use of CSS. We will learn how to customise a table later when we learn about CSS.

You will also discover HTML tables are not the best mechanism to describe the layout of an HTML page. Although you can place the various sections in columns, rows and cells, they do not make your pages responsive. Later, you will also learn about styling with grids and other structural elements.

Dig deeper

- Read HTML tables (GeeksforGeeks, 2025)^{fnref:d3743b} to learn more about attributes that can be used on the <table> element. This will help you if you do

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not know how to use the <table> element and attributes that can be used alongside it.

- View more examples at HTML tag (W3Schools.com, n.d.)^{fnref:b3302c} to understand how to write the HTML code and what that code will produce.



Refer to the HTML cheat sheets from the start of the topic for help creating tables.

Basics of HTML (self-study/revision) →



Thoughts on this page?

